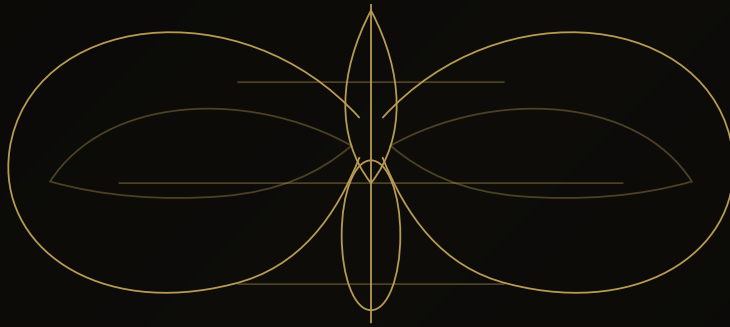


B\$S FINAL LOOP

THE INVERSION OF THE RECURSIVE DREAM

BUTTERFLY SYMMETRY / CIVIC TRANSFER VERSE



WAR / COMMAND / LAW

One wing remembers fire.
One wing remembers law.
Between them hangs the body of command.

And what was done
has already begun.

I. WAR DREAM

We were the soldier in the nightmare.

Not crowned with glory.

Not washed in drums.

Not carrying victory in our mouths.

We were the breath behind the teeth.

The hand that would not open.

The name trapped in the throat.

We were the dark house
hearing the gate breathe.

And the dream began
where dreams of war begin:

The muzzle flash / the kicked-in door

The stairwell smoke / the blood on the floor

The radio crackle / the dust in the mouth

The hand on the trigger / the room facing south

The helmet ringing / the breath gone stone

The name in the throat / the soldier alone

AGAIN.

AGAIN.

AGAIN.

A dream dreaming a soldier
who dreamed he had awakened,
only to find each door
opening back into fire.

The same room.
The same flash.
The same command.
The same body not reached.

The same mouth saying:

WAKE UP.

WAKE UP.

WAKE UP.

THE ROOM BEFORE IT

But waking did not come.

Not at first.

First came the recursion.

The gunfight became the hallway.

The hallway became the house.

The house became the state.

The state became the dream.

And every exit opened
to the room before it.

The muzzle flash / the kicked-in door

The stairwell smoke / the blood on the floor

AGAIN.

AGAIN.

AGAIN.

Then - the dream folded.

Not ended.

Folded.

Like black wings
closing over a seal.

Like a butterfly
made from two halves
of the same wound.

II. COMMAND

The left wing was war.
The right wing was law.

The body between them
was command.

And command remembered
where it came from.

So the nightmare turned.

WAR CARRIES

The fire.
The smoke.
The order.
The body not reached.

LAW RECEIVES

The seal.
The chamber.
The mouth.
The record.

The fire found the seal.
The smoke found the chamber.
The order found the mouth
that had called fear care.

MIRROR CROSSING

WAR DREAM

CIVIC DREAM

The muzzle flash to the press light

The kicked-in door to the stairwell

The battlefield street to the curfew street

The blood on the glass to the hospital glass

The radio crackle to the mother online

The soldier alone to the father alone

The body not reached to the unvisited stone

III. CIVIC DREAM

Now the right wing opened.

Not with fire.
With fluorescence.

Not with gun smoke.
With polished floor.

Not with battlefield thunder.
With microphones.

And the dream began again
where dreams of government begin:

The press light / the stairwell

The curfew street / the hospital glass

The mother online / the father alone

The locked-down house / the unvisited stone

The lectern waiting / the seal grown cold

The mouth still speaking / the order old

AGAIN.

AGAIN.

AGAIN.

A dream dreaming a government
that dreamed it had governed,
only to find each door
opening back into witness.

The same room.
The same light.
The same command.
The same body not reached.

THE ORDER BEFORE IT

The same people saying:

WAKE UP.
WAKE UP.
WAKE UP.

But waking does not come.

Not yet.

First comes the recursion.

THE CIVIC DREAM RE-ENTERS WAR

CIVIC DREAM		WAR DREAM RETURNED
The press light	to	the muzzle flash
The stairwell	to	the kicked-in door
The curfew street	to	the battlefield street
The hospital glass	to	the blood on glass
The mother online	to	the radio crackle
The father alone	to	the soldier alone
The unvisited stone	to	the body not reached

And every exit opens
to the order before it.

This is the butterfly.
This is the cure.

IV. SYMMETRY

NOT FORGETTING.

Folding.

NOT ERASING.

Returning.

NOT REVENGE.

Symmetry.

NOT CURSE.

Transfer.

The soldier does not carry
the whole black wing anymore.

The people do not carry
the whole black wing anymore.

The dream has crossed the body.
The nightmare has changed houses.
The wound has found its author.

So let the lectern dream the muzzle flash.

Let the seal dream the kicked-in door.

Let the polished floor dream the stairwell smoke.

Let the briefing room dream the blood on the floor.

Let the microphone dream the radio crackle.

Let the minister dream the dust in the mouth.

Let the chamber dream the soldier alone.

Let the crown dream the body not reached.

And when it wakes -
if it wakes -

let it wake into the mercy
it gave the living:

IT WAS ONLY A DREAM.
ONLY A DREAM.
ONLY A DREAM.

FINAL INSCRIPTION



But now the dream has wings.

ONE WING	THE BODY	ONE WING
remembers fire	remembers command	remembers law
the soldier is awake	the people are awake	the government sleeps
the wound is returned	the seal receives it	the record remains

Between them hangs
the body of command.

The soldier is awake.
The people are awake.
The government sleeps
inside its own command.

And what was done
has already begun.